

Historic Nights from Kamilla Cardoso and Courtney Vandersloot Power Chicago Sky to First Win of the Season Against the Dallas Wings

By Caleb Evans

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It was an announced sellout crowd at Wintrust Arena for the Sky's game against the Dallas Wings Thursday. Fans eager to witness the highly anticipated matchup between Paige Bueckers and Angel Reese, two of the WNBA's most promising young stars. However, it was Kamilla Cardoso who ignited the Sky's first victory of the season on this night in May.

"Today I was actually able to make layups," Cardoso said

Cardoso made seven layups on her way to a career-high 23 points, leading the Sky to a 97-92 victory over the Wings and earning them their first win in six games this season on a night marked by several special moments.

From the start, Cardoso's dominance inside set the tone. The 6-foot-7 center scored the first 10 points for the Sky, finishing the first quarter with 12 of the team's 29 points.

"Kamilla can be a dominant force in this league," Sky coach Tyler Marsh said.

With an overall emphasis on feeding the paint, as expressed by Marsh before the game, the Sky overcame their continued struggles making close shots through sheer volume and by getting to the free-throw line.

Much of that volume came from veteran Courtney Vandersloot, who finished the game with nine assists.

"I think she (Cardoso) needs to touch the ball a lot," Vandersloot said.

Vandersloot, in her 15th year, rejoined the Sky this offseason after spending the first 12 years of her career in Chicago. On Women's Cancer Awareness Night at Wintrust Arena, Vandersloot played through the emotions of losing her mother to cancer a little less than a year ago. In a poetic twist, Vandersloot scored her 3,724th point in a Sky uniform, breaking the franchise record previously held by her wife, Allie Quigley.

"It was a perfect moment," Vandersloot said.

Unfortunately for the Sky, the perfect moment, that was the first half turned into a struggle, as the Wings scored 30 points in the third quarter, allowing Dallas to take the lead after trailing by as many as 13. Dallas' surge came behind a flurry of tough shots from Arike Ogunbowale, who had a game-high 37 points, along with some big plays from Bueckers, who finished with 15 points, eight assists, and five rebounds.

As for Reese, she struggled, finishing with only six points on 33% shooting and nine rebounds and five assists. Even still, the Sky responded with grit in the fourth quarter. The teams traded buckets throughout the period, but Cardoso, Vandersloot and the rest of the squad made more plays down the stretch.

"Everyone in the fourth quarter made a winning play," Vandersloot said

Marsh stressed the importance of not being complacent, especially since the Sky will face the Wings again on Saturday in Dallas.

"It's great to get our first win, but we're not going to celebrate too long," Marsh said.